

details are obscure. About 60 musical compositions attributed to him survive, almost all of them religious, including two complete Masses and various other settings of sacred Latin texts. His style is notable for its melodic freshness and sweetness. He was highly regarded in Europe—indeed, he has been described as “the most influential English composer outside England before the Beatles.”

KEY WORKS: Missa Rex seculorum (Mass of the King of Ages); Salve Regina, mater misericordiae (Hail Queen, Mother of Mercy); O crux gloriosa (O Glorious Cross); dates unknown

Johannes Ockeghem

c. 1410–1497, FRANCO-FLEMISH

Ockeghem was Flemish but he spent most of his long career working for three successive kings at the French court (then based mainly in Tours, rather than Paris). The political geography of the time was complex and places of origin are often uncertain, so he is one of a number of composers whose nationality is characterized by the broad term Franco-Flemish. He was admired for his honesty and generosity as well as his musical skills and